PROJECT DEVELOPMENT

STREAMLINING IT PROCUREMENT: AUTOMATING STASNDARD LAPTOP ORDERS WITH FLOW DESIGNER

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1.INTRODUCTION

The project "Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Tasks" focuses on developing an automated workflow for standard laptop procurement using ServiceNow Flow Designer.In the existing process, standard laptop requests may require manual intervention for approval, task creation, assignment, and configuration. This can cause delays and increase the workload of the IT procurement and hardware teams.The developed solution automates the creation of a Catalog Task after the laptop request is approved. The task is automatically assigned to the Hardware assignment group with the required task description.

2.PROJECT OBJECTIVES

The main objective of this project is to automate the standard laptop procurement process using ServiceNow Flow Designer.

2.1OBJECTIVES

- To create an automated workflow for standard laptop requests.
- To generate a Catalog Task after approval.
- To reduce manual intervention in the procurement process.
- To automatically assign the task to the Hardware group.
- To provide the required task description automatically.
- To reduce user waiting time.
- To improve the efficiency of the IT procurement process.
- To support better utilization of IT resources.
- To minimize errors caused by manual task creation and assignment.

The project is designed to make the standard laptop procurement and configuration process more streamlined and efficient.

3.DEVELOPMENT ENVIRONMENT

The project is developed using the ServiceNow platform and its Flow Designer feature.

3.1Technology Used

- ❖ ServiceNow:

ServiceNow is used as the platform for managing the standard laptop request and procurement workflow.

- ❖ Flow Designer:

Flow Designer is used to automate the process. It creates the required Catalog Task after the request receives approval.

- ❖ Service Catalog:

The Service Catalog provides the Standard Laptop item through which users can place a laptop request.

- ❖ Catalog Task:

The Catalog Task represents the task that needs to be performed by the hardware team for laptop configuration.

3.2. Development Flow

The basic development process is:

Standard Laptop Request → Approval → Flow Designer → Create Catalog Task → Hardware Assignment → Laptop Configuration

This workflow connects the Service Catalog request with the automated task creation process.

4.FLOW CREATION

The first major development activity is creating a Flow in ServiceNow.

Steps to Create the Flow

1. Open the ServiceNow application.

2. Select All from the application menu.

3. Search for Flow Designer.

4. Open Flow Designer under Process Automation.

5. Select New.

6. Choose Flow.

7. Enter the Flow name as “Standard laptop task”.

8. Select Global as the application.

9. Set the Run As option to System user.

10. Submit the Flow.

After creating the Flow, a trigger is added to determine when the automation should start.

4.1. Flow Purpose

The Flow is designed to process the Standard Laptop request after the required approval and automatically create a task for the hardware team.

5.TRIGGER AND CATALOG TASK ACTION

After creating the Flow, the next step is configuring the trigger.

Trigger Configuration

1. Select Add a Trigger.

2. Search for Service Catalog.

3. Select the Service Catalog trigger.

4. Click Done.

The trigger connects the Service Catalog request with the Flow.

Create Catalog Task Action

After configuring the trigger:

1. Select Actions.

2. Click Add an Action.

3. Search for Create Catalog Task.

4. Select the Create Catalog Task action.

This action is responsible for creating the task required for laptop configuration.

The Requested Item Record is used as the Request item, and the table is automatically populated as Catalog Task.

6.TASK CONFIGURATION

The Catalog Task action is configured with the required information.

Short Description

The Short Description is entered as:

“Laptop need to Configured”

Description

The description field is also configured with:

“Laptop need to Configured”

Assignment Group

The Assignment Group is set to:

Hardware

This ensures that the generated task is assigned to the appropriate hardware team.

Approval

The Approval field is configured as:

Approved

The remaining fields are kept with their default values, and the action configuration is completed by selecting Done.

This configuration ensures that the required Catalog Task is generated with the correct information and assignment.

7.SAVE, ACTIVATE AND ASSIGN THE FLOW

After completing the Flow configuration, the Flow is saved and activated.

Save and Activate

1. Review the configured Flow.

2. Select Save.

3. Activate the Flow.

The activated Flow can then be assigned to the Standard Laptop catalog item.

Flow Assignment

The Standard Laptop item is opened through the relevant Service Catalog configuration.

The process includes:

1. Open Maintain Items.

2. Select Standard Laptop.

3. Open Process Engine.

4. Remove the remaining automations where required.

5. Add the newly created Flow.

6. Select Standard Laptop Task.

7. Save the configuration.

This connects the developed Flow with the Standard Laptop catalog item.

8.SERVICE CATALOG REQUEST

After assigning the Flow, the Standard Laptop request is tested through the Service Catalog.

Request Creation

1. Open All.

2. Select Service Catalog.

3. Open Hardware.

4. Select Standard Laptop.

5. Click Order Now.

This creates a Standard Laptop request in the system.

The request can then be monitored through the order status and request number. The request record provides access to the relevant approval and requested item information.

9.APPROVAL AND CATALOG TASK VERIFICATION

After creating the request, the approval process is performed.

Approval Process

1. Check the Order Status.

2. Open the Request Number.

3. Open the Requested Record.

4. Select Approvers.

5. Approve the request.

6. Open the Requested Item section.

7. Open the Requested Item.

After approval, the Flow processes the request and creates the required Catalog Task.

Catalog Task Verification

The Catalog Tasks section is opened and the generated task record is selected.

The following details are verified:

- Task status

- Short Description

- Assigned Group

The task should show the configured description “Laptop need to Configured” and the Assignment Group as Hardware.

10.TESTING AND RESULTS

Testing

The developed workflow is tested by placing a Standard Laptop request through the Service Catalog and completing the approval process.

The main points checked during testing are:

- ✓ Standard Laptop request is created successfully.
- ✓ Approval is completed.
- ✓ Flow is triggered.
- ✓ Catalog Task is created.
- ✓ Short Description is updated correctly.
- ✓ Assignment Group is set to Hardware.
- ✓ Task details are displayed correctly.

Result

The developed Flow successfully connects the Standard Laptop request with the required Catalog Task. After approval, the task is generated with the configured description and assigned to the Hardware group.

CONCLUSION

The project successfully demonstrates the use of ServiceNow Flow Designer to automate standard laptop procurement tasks. The automation reduces manual intervention and supports timely laptop configuration.By automatically creating and assigning Catalog Tasks after approval, the developed solution helps reduce user waiting time, improve IT team productivity, and support better resource utilization.